

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What acidity percentage should vinegar have to safely pickle vegetables at home?**

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**5% acidity vinegar**

## FUN FACT

*Using 5% acidity vinegar stops dangerous bacteria like Clostridium botulinum from growing.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**Why should the blossom end of cucumbers be cut off before pickling?**

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**It contains enzymes that can soften the pickles**

## FUN FACT

*Cutting off just 1/16 inch of the blossom end improves pickle texture.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What metal utensils should NOT be used when pickling because they can react with acid or salt?**

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Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**Zinc, copper, brass, galvanized metal, or iron**

## FUN FACT

*Using reactive metal can cause changes in color and safety of your pickles.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What is the role of salt in fermenting vegetables like sauerkraut or kimchi?**

# PICKLING

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## ANSWER

**It helps control bacterial growth and creates a firm texture**

## FUN FACT

*Salt also helps good lactic acid bacteria grow during fermentation.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



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Q

**How long should cucumbers soak in pickling lime water to get firm pickles?**

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Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**12 to 24 hours with several rinses**

## FUN FACT

*Pickling lime makes pickles crisp but must be rinsed well before pickling.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**Which type of salt is recommended for pickling brine to get the best results?**

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Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

### Canning or pickling salt

## FUN FACT

*Some salts have additives that cloud the brine or add impurities, so pickling salt is best.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What is the minimum headspace to leave in jars when packing vegetables hot for pickling?**

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## ANSWER

**1/2 inch headspace**

## FUN FACT

*Leaving the right headspace helps vacuum seals form during processing.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What temperature method is used to safely process jars of pickles to prevent spoilage?**

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## ANSWER

### Boiling water canning

## FUN FACT

*Boiling water canning times vary by altitude to ensure safety.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



# PICKLING

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## Q

**What happens if you reduce the amount of vinegar in a pickling recipe?**

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## ANSWER

**The acidity may be too low to prevent harmful bacteria**

## FUN FACT

*Never reduce vinegar concentration in tested recipes for safety.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**Why must fermented pickles be kept under the brine during fermentation?**

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## ANSWER

**To keep them away from air to prevent mold**

## FUN FACT

*A weight is used to keep vegetables submerged in the salty water.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What is a common acid besides vinegar used to help safely pickle mushrooms?**

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## ANSWER

### Bottled lemon juice

## FUN FACT

*Lemon juice helps keep mushrooms safe and adds flavor in pickling.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**How long should cucumbers be stored after processing to develop ideal flavor for firm pickles?**

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**4 to 5 weeks**

## FUN FACT

*Pickles keep improving in texture and taste as they age in jars.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What is the standard vinegar acidity recommended for all quick pickling recipes?**

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Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**5% acidity**

## FUN FACT

*5% vinegar acidity is a reliable safety level for home pickling.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**Which vegetable size is best to select for making dill pickles?**

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Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**3- to 4-inch cucumbers**

## FUN FACT

*Smaller cucumbers generally make crisper, better-textured pickles.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

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## Q

**Why should you not use reduced-sodium salt in fermented pickles like sauerkraut?**

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## ANSWER

**Because sodium controls bacterial growth and texture in fermentation**

## FUN FACT

*Salt amount is critical for successful fermentation safety and quality.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**How is pickling salt different from table salt for home pickling?**

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## ANSWER

**It is pure salt without additives that cloud brine**

## FUN FACT

*Pure pickling salt keeps brine clear and pickle texture firm.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What happens during the fermenting process of vegetables like kimchi or sauerkraut?**

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**Lactic acid bacteria produce acid that preserves the vegetables**

## FUN FACT

*Fermentation takes several weeks but creates unique flavors and safety.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

Q

**What is the role of sugar in sweet pickle recipes?**

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## ANSWER

**To balance the acidity and add sweetness**

## FUN FACT

*Sugar and vinegar balance flavor but sugar is not a preservative by itself.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

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**What type of container is recommended for fermenting large batches of pickles at home?**

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## ANSWER

**Food-grade stoneware crock  
or glass container**

## FUN FACT

*Using the right container keeps  
fermentation safe and tasty.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

## Q

**How should jars be prepared before filling with pickles for canning?**

# PICKLING

Teens (14–18)

## ANSWER

**They should be hot and sterilized**

## FUN FACT

*Hot sterilized jars help prevent contamination during processing.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables